

ICFAI Founders Network — User Guide

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Welcome to the ICFAI Founders Network

A private home for ICFAI founders and the people who guide them. This guide covers everything you can do across the network — from the community spaces to the tools for reviewing and advancing ideas.

1. Getting started

YOUR ACCOUNT

- If your account was set up for you, you'll receive an email with a temporary password. Sign in with it, then change it in **Settings**.
- If you registered yourself, open the confirmation link we email you, then sign in.
- Forgot your password? On the login screen choose **Forgot password** and follow the email.

SETTING UP YOUR PROFILE

The first time you sign in, you'll complete a short profile: your name, region, sector, and domain, plus optional details. This takes a minute and unlocks the rest of the app. Edit it anytime from **Profile** or **Settings**.

2. Finding your way around

- **Left rail** — Feed, Idea Pipeline, Problem Hub, Team Acquisition, Directory, the Autopsy Library, and your review workspace.
 - **Top bar** — a calendar shortcut, the **bell** for notifications, and your **profile menu**.
 - **The bell** — recent notifications and upcoming events. It includes filters to focus on what needs you (see §6).
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3. The community spaces

- **Feed** — share updates, run polls, raise problems, vote, and comment. Pinned posts sit on top.
 - **Problem Hub** — real, unsolved problems with open solution threads. A great place to point founders.
 - **Team Acquisition** — *Hiring for your startup? Post a role. Want to join one? Apply.* Post role needs or apply to others'; posters review applicants.
 - **Directory** — search every member by role, sector, or region.
 - **Autopsy Library** — honest post-mortems of failed ideas and the lessons behind them.
 - **Calendar** — upcoming sessions, deadlines, and events.
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4. The Idea Pipeline

A guided path that takes an idea from first submission to incubation. Every idea carries its own **IFN-#** reference and moves through six gates.

Gate	Stage	What it means
G1	Idea Submitted	The application is in the queue, waiting to be picked up.
G2	Assigned	An administrator has assigned the idea, awaiting acceptance.
G3	Picked Up	The founder completes the full dossier — details and files.
G4	Review Completed	The dossier passed the rubric; the founder submits a beta plan.
G5	Beta Prototyping	Building. Advancing requires evidence — a prototype link or files.
G6	Incubation	Confirmed for incubation; work continues via actions and the thread.

Each idea shows a status chip — **Your move**, **With reviewer**, **In the queue**, **Needs admin**, or **Done** — so it's always clear who holds it next. An idea can stay **Active**, be sent back to **Refine & retry**, or be **Rejected**.

5. Reviewing and advancing ideas

Open your review workspace from **Mentor Review** in the left rail. This is where assigned ideas live and where you move them forward.

THE WORKFLOW

1. **Accept an assignment.** When an idea is assigned to you, it appears in your workspace. Accept it to pick it up (this moves the idea to *Picked Up*).
2. **Read the dossier.** Review the founder's details, files, and thread.
3. **Score on the rubric.** Evaluate against the seven criteria:
 - Clarity
 - Feasibility
 - Market potential
 - Innovation
 - Technical strength
 - Scalability
 - Problem–solution fit
4. **Decide.** Advance the idea to the next gate, or send it back as **Refine & retry** with guidance. Refine is the most useful tool you have — be specific about what would make it stronger.
5. **Keep the thread alive.** Use the idea's thread and actions to keep momentum between gates, especially through **Beta Prototyping**.

EVIDENCE AND FUNDING

To advance an idea out of **Beta Prototyping**, look for real evidence — a working prototype link or supporting files. When the prototype needs funding to progress, there's a path to flag it for incubation funding.

Tip: A clear, specific *Refine & retry* note saves rounds of back-and-forth. Tie every request to a rubric criterion.

6. Notifications

The bell and the full notifications page give you focused views:

- **Needs action** — what's waiting on you right now.
- **All activity** — the broader stream across your work.
- **Mine** — items you're involved in.

Choose **Expand notifications** to open the full page. The badge on the bell shows unread items.

7. Settings and your account

From **Settings** you can update your profile, change your password, set notification preferences, and sign out of every device at once.

8. If something looks off

- **Read-only or suspended account:** an administrator has restricted it — contact the IFN team if that's unexpected.
 - **Can't post:** posting may be temporarily paused.
 - **Trouble signing in:** use **Forgot password**; after several quick attempts a short cooldown applies.
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Thank you for guiding the next set of founders.